
PAULA RIQUELME

PRODUCT LEAD · PRODUCT DESIGNER · FRONTEND DEVELOPER

Concepción, Biobío, Chile | paula.riq.esco@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/pauriquelme

PROFILE

Product Lead, product designer, and tech entrepreneur with 8+ years building and leading digital products. Industrial Engineer with a master's degree in Innovation and Technology Entrepreneurship. Bridges discovery, product strategy, UX/UI, and frontend implementation to turn real customer problems into useful, market-ready products.

CORE SKILLS

Product: Product strategy, product discovery, customer research, roadmaps, UX/UI, prototyping, go-to-market, and agile delivery.

Design: Figma, Adobe Illustrator, and Adobe Premiere Pro at advanced proficiency.

Development: TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Next.js, Vite, and AI-assisted development with Claude Code, Codex, and Kimi. Working knowledge of MongoDB, NestJS, AWS, and Azure.

SELECTED EXPERIENCE

CEO & Co-founder / Product Lead | woku

September 2023 - Present | Chile

- Leads end-to-end strategy and execution for an AI-powered customer feedback platform, from discovery and workflow design through frontend implementation and launch.
- Translates customer needs into rapid feedback capture, NPS and forms, AI-assisted analysis, alerts, and WhatsApp and API integrations.
- Connects product, UX/UI, growth, sales, and implementation to align the roadmap with real workflows and business outcomes.
- Won more than 50 customers across Chile, Peru, and Colombia, and secured USD 70,000 in non-dilutive, equity-free funding from CORFO.

Co-founder & Brand Artisan, Product Design | Inpla

May 2025 - January 2026 | Chile

- Won the first customer, Puerto Coronel, before a product existed by selling the vision alone.
- Co-created the product, user experience, brand, and positioning for a platform that allows companies to chat with their data.

CEO & Co-founder | stow SpA

October 2020 - December 2022 | Concepción, Chile

- Built a Chilean technology startup from concept to market across product strategy, design, development, sales, and operations.
- Selected for Start-Up Chile BUILD in 2022 and received USD 10,000 in non-dilutive, equity-free funding.

PAULA RIQUELME

EXPERIENCE, EDUCATION & RECOGNITION

Maintenance Planning Engineer | Essbio

May 2019 - July 2021 | Concepción, Chile

- Led an innovation process with 30 technicians to improve maintenance processes using Carlos Osorio's (defi)2 methodology.
- Created data models and decision-support visualizations for maintenance planning.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lecturer | Universidad de Concepción

2023 | Chile

- Taught Business Management and coached students in Project Formulation and Evaluation.

CEO | Orvita

2018 - 2019 | Chile

- Led strategy and product development for a digital tourism venture using funding obtained after the OPTIMA 2017 recognition.

EDUCATION

Master's in Innovation and Technology Entrepreneurship | Universidad de Concepción, 2023

Industrial Engineering | Universidad de Concepción, 2018

RECOGNITION

Best Undergraduate Paper | OPTIMA 2017

Developed an algorithm based on the traveling salesperson problem to recommend tourist routes according to a visitor's interests, available time, and budget. The work received the Best Undergraduate Paper award at the OPTIMA 2017 Congress and made it possible to obtain USD 7,000 from the Chilean Institute for Operations Research, ICHIO, to develop Orvita.

PRESS

Featured five times in El Mercurio Innovation for Woku, Inpla, entrepreneurship, startup closure, and Made Inn Conce 2024. Diario Concepción also covered the OPTIMA 2017 recognition.

Portfolio: <https://PauRiquelmee.github.io/paula-riquelme-portfolio/>

Woku: <https://woku.app> | Inpla: <https://inpla.ai/en/> | Methodology: <https://defi2.cc/>

LANGUAGES

English: full professional proficiency.